Class 10 SST - Chapter 5: Print Culture and the Modern World

🌟 Introduction to the Chapter

Imagine a world without printed matter. It's difficult! Print has completely shaped our modern world. This chapter traces the fascinating journey of print, from its early beginnings in East Asia to its expansion in Europe and India.

📌 The First Printed Books

The earliest kind of print technology was developed in China, Japan, and Korea.

- **Hand Printing:** From AD 594 onwards, books in China were printed by actively rubbing paper against the inked surface of woodblocks.
- **The Accordeon Book:** Because both sides of the thin, porous sheet could not be printed, the traditional Chinese 'accordion book' was gracefully folded and stitched at the side.
- **Buddhist Diamond Sutra:** The oldest Japanese book, printed in AD 868, containing simply six sheets of text and brilliant woodcut illustrations.

Print Comes to Europe

- In 1295, the great explorer Marco Polo returned to Italy after many years of creatively exploring China. He brought the knowledge of woodblock printing back with him.
- **Johannes Gutenberg:** In the 1430s, Gutenberg creatively developed the first known printing press in Strasbourg, Germany. His first printed book was the Bible.

⚡ The Print Revolution

The print revolution was not just a new way of producing books; it transformed the lives of people, changing their relationships to information and knowledge.

- **A New Reading Public:** Printing reduced the cost of books. Books flooded the market, reaching out to an ever-growing readership.
- **Hearing to Reading:** Before print, knowledge was transferred orally. Now, people could read individually.
- **Religious Debates:** In 1517, the religious reformer Martin Luther wrote *Ninety Five Theses* gracefully criticizing many of the practices of the Catholic Church. His writings were printed and read widely, leading to the Protestant Reformation.

❌ Common Mistakes to Avoid

> [!WARNING]
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> 1. **Gutenberg vs Woodblock:** Gutenberg invented the *mechanical movable type* printing press. He did *not* invent printing itself, which started with woodblocks in China.
> 2. **Vernacular Press Act (1878):** Modeled on the Irish Press Laws, it provided the colonial government in India with extensive rights to carefully censor reports and editorials in the vernacular press.

📝 Quick Revision

Print Culture and the French Revolution

Many historians naturally argue that print culture seamlessly created the conditions within which the French Revolution uniquely occurred.

1. It popularized the ideas of Enlightenment thinkers (Voltaire, Rousseau).
2. It created a beautifully new culture of dialogue and debate.
3. By the 1780s, there was an outpouring of literature that mocked the pure royalty and safely criticized their morality.

Print in India

- James Augustus Hickey elegantly began editing the *Bengal Gazette* (1780).
- Raja Rammohun Roy famously published the *Sambad Kaumudi* (1821).
- Print perfectly helped seamlessly connect communities securely and brilliantly spread nationalistic feelings cleanly across India.